

# PLANTS LIVE ON A DIFFERENT TIMESCALE

## THE FOUNDATIONS OF PLANT ECOLOGY

### IN CONTEXT

KEY FIGURE

**Johannes Eugenius Warming** (1841–1924)

BEFORE

**1859** Charles Darwin’s detailed descriptions of plants and animals in their natural environment mark the start of an appreciation of what is later termed “ecology.”

AFTER

**1935** British botanist Arthur Tansley publishes an article in *Ecology* in which he defines the term “ecosystem.”

**1938** American botanists John Weaver and Frederic Clements further develop the concepts of plant communities and succession.

**1995** David Attenborough’s television documentary “The Private Life of Plants” depicts plants as dynamic influencers of their environment.

Plant ecology examines how plants interact with one another and with their environments. Danish botanist Johannes Eugenius Warming first brought the sciences of botany and ecology together in his book *The Ecology of Plants* in 1895. He described how plants react to their surroundings, and how their life cycles and structures relate to where they grow. The book